

Standards Crosswalk

How the Economic Democracy concept library and teaching units map to the standards schools already recognize — the Council for Economic Education's economics pillars and the C3 inquiry dimensions. Built to be standards-completing, not standards-rejecting: it shows where the course covers the existing economics canon, and is honest about where it does not.

How to read this. Coverage is marked at the **pillar level** — the grain at which a course actually aligns — not by individual sub-benchmark code. CEE distributes its full numbered benchmark text as a published volume; exact sub-benchmark numbering should be confirmed against that document before any formal submission. Pillar *themes* below reflect the CEE 2025 third edition (18 pillars, ~260 benchmarks, Technology new this edition), verified against current CEE/EconEdLink sources, May 2026.

- **Full** — a primer or unit centers this pillar ● **Partial** — touched within other materials; not its own primer
- **Gap** — not yet built (none remain among the CEE pillars; shown for reference)

01 CEE Economics Pillars → Built Materials

Each row maps a CEE 2025 economics pillar (by verified theme) to the concept primers and units that cover it. The course is strongest on the microeconomic foundations, market structure, and the money/ownership material — its distinctive territory — and, with the policy and labor primers now in place, also covers the macro-stabilization pillars a traditional sequence centers. The result is broad pillar coverage plus the power/ownership depth a conventional course lacks.

CEE PILLAR (THEME)	COV.	MAPPED PRIMERS / UNITS	NOTES
Scarcity & choice	●	Scarcity; Opportunity Cost	The foundational pair; directly on-pillar.
Decision-making & incentives	●	Incentives; Opportunity Cost	Incentives primer centers predictable response to rewards/penalties.
Productivity & growth	●	Productivity; Compounding; Creative Destruction	Output-per-hour, compounding growth, and the disruption mechanism.
Markets & prices (exchange)	●	Supply & Demand; Competition; Profit Motive; Incentives	The price-as-signal mechanism is now its own primer; voluntary exchange and the profit signal build on it.
Competition & market structure	●	Competition; Monopoly; Network Effects; Economies of Scale	A notably deep area — the whole Power cluster lives here.
Market failure & externalities	●	The Commons; Rent-Seeking; Monopoly	Tragedy/governance, value-capture, and concentration as failures.
Role of government & market failure	●	Fiscal Policy; Taxation; Redistribution; The Commons (governance); Rent-Seeking; Predistribution	Fiscal Policy, Taxation, and Redistribution center government's economic role and the moving of resources by collective rule; the corrective role also runs through the others.
Labor & income	●	Labor; Wages & Assets; Taxation; Small Business Owner; Predistribution; Redistribution	Labor centers the factor market and the three kinds of unemployment; wage-vs-asset income, how taxation falls on it, and the predistribution-vs-redistribution debate are central threads.
Economic institutions	●	The Corporation; The Trust; Ownership & Equity; Capital; The Entrepreneur	Legal-person, trustee/beneficiary, ownership, the asset that compounds, and the risk-bearing founder.
Money & its functions	●	Banking & Central Banks; Cryptocurrency; Credit; Debt	How money is created and governed; what makes anything money; credit/debt as trust and obligation.
Interest, credit & saving	●	Credit; Debt; Compounding	Borrowing the future; the fixed obligation; interest both directions.
Money & inflation	●	Inflation; Banking & Central Banks	General price rise and its silent redistribution, plus how money creation and central-bank policy drive it.
Income, employment & output (GDP)	●	The Wealth of Nations; The Wealth of the Nation; Business Cycles; Fiscal Policy; P&L vs. Balance Sheet	National output, employment, and the flow-vs-stock distinction now well covered; formal GDP-accounting mechanics remain light.

CEE PILLAR (THEME)	COV.	MAPPED PRIMERS / UNITS	NOTES
Unemployment	●	Labor	Labor primer treats the three kinds of unemployment — frictional, structural, cyclical — directly.
Economic fluctuations (business cycle)	●	Business Cycles	The four-phase cycle as the economy's rhythm — its own primer, mechanics-led.
Trade & interdependence	●	Globalization; Sovereignty; The Wealth of Nations	Globalization now centers comparative advantage and cross-border integration directly; interdependence and chokepoints run through Sovereignty.
Fiscal & monetary policy	●	Fiscal Policy; Taxation; Banking & Central Banks	Both hands on the wheel now have dedicated primers — the budget and tax levers, and the money/credit lever.
Technology (new 2025)	●	Data; Network Effects; Creative Destruction; Predistribution	The course's strongest differentiator — squarely meets CEE's newest pillar.

What the pattern shows. The course covers the conceptual economics spine with notable depth in **market structure, institutions, money/ownership, and technology** — the last being CEE's newest pillar and the course's sharpest point of differentiation. With the addition of dedicated **Supply & Demand, Labor, Business Cycles, Banking & Central Banks, Fiscal Policy**, and **Globalization** primers, the macro-stabilization, price-mechanism, and trade pillars that were formerly partial or absent are now directly covered. Coverage is now full or near-full across the canon; only formal GDP-accounting mechanics remain lighter, appearing inside other primers rather than as a standalone procedural treatment.

What remains lighter — honestly. The macro-stabilization pillars that were once genuine gaps — **unemployment, the business cycle, and fiscal/monetary policy** — are now each covered by a dedicated primer (Labor, Business Cycles, and Fiscal Policy plus Banking & Central Banks), and **comparative-advantage trade theory** is now centered by the Globalization primer rather than merely touched. What stays lighter is narrower and procedural: formal **GDP-accounting mechanics** — the course teaches what national output is and how it's divided, but not the line-by-line measurement conventions. That is not a conceptual hole; it is procedural depth a teacher can supplement, and naming it is what keeps the rest of the crosswalk credible.

02 C3 Inquiry Dimensions → Course Design

Where CEE supplies the content spine, the C3 Framework supplies the inquiry and rigor axis. The course's pedagogy — structured argument, source analysis, role-play, and a defended-stance capstone — maps cleanly onto all four C3 dimensions, which is the part a social-studies department will check.

DIMENSION 1 Developing Questions & Planning Inquiries Every primer is built on a compelling question ("what makes anything money?", "who is a corporation for?") and ends with discussion questions that drive further inquiry. The reform test ("the smallest change that...") is itself a planning prompt.	DIMENSION 2 Applying Disciplinary Concepts & Tools This is the concept library's core function: 36 economic tools (scarcity, supply & demand, competition, compounding, market failure, capital, ownership, taxation, redistribution, globalization) taught to be applied, then applied across real contexts in each primer's Section III.
DIMENSION 3 Evaluating Sources & Using Evidence The activity tables and "argue it both ways" write tasks require students to weigh competing claims and marshal evidence for a position. The Core Anthology (250 voices) supplies primary-source range.	DIMENSION 4 Communicating Conclusions & Taking Informed Action Every primer closes with a defended-stance write task; the Human Flourishing capstone ("Define & Defend") and the Role-Play Lab are sustained Dimension-4 performance tasks built around deliberation and civic decision.

C3 fit is strong across all four dimensions — and notably, the course leans into exactly the inquiry-and-action pedagogies (structured discussion, simulation, source analysis, performance tasks) that the evidence base favors and that a textbook can't easily supply. This is the course's pedagogical differentiator, not just a compliance checkbox.

03 **Secondary Alignments & Notes**

Beyond the two core frameworks, the course touches the other standards schools weigh. These are noted rather than fully mapped, to keep the crosswalk legible.

FRAMEWORK	FIT	NOTE
AP Microeconomics	●	Strong overlap on market structure, competition, market failure, factor (labor) markets, and the role of government including taxation and its incidence. Lighter on formal cost-curve / perfect-competition graphing.
AP Macroeconomics	●	Partial overlap, now meaningfully improved — Business Cycles, Banking & Central Banks, Fiscal Policy, Labor (unemployment), and Inflation cover the core stabilization concepts. Lighter on formal AD/AS graphing and GDP-accounting mechanics; a strong conceptual complement, not a full exam-prep substitute.
Jump\$tart / CEE Personal Finance	●	Credit, Debt, Ownership & Equity, Compounding, and Inflation carry real personal-finance content, framed structurally rather than as money-management how-to. Complements an NGPF-style PF course; does not replace it.
C3 (full)	●	See §02 — all four dimensions covered.

The adoption case in one line. Against the verified CEE 2025 pillars, the course now delivers full or near-full coverage on all 18 — including the newest (Technology) — with only formal GDP-accounting mechanics remaining as a procedural (not conceptual) light spot a teacher can supplement. On C3, it covers all four inquiry dimensions and leans into the evidence-favored pedagogies. That is the literal meaning of *standards-completing*, *not standards-rejecting*: it unifies the power/ownership/institutions inquiry the traditional frameworks underdeliver, while mapping onto essentially the entire economics canon they already require.